St James 'Office Hours' Rogaine
Sunday 4th December 2011

Dear Team,

Team No.

Thank you for your entry. **Please get your team number from the website, enter it here, bring it with you, and remember it.**

As team contact person, please ensure all team members are familiar with this information. It is also accessible at www.rogaine.org.nz. We hope you enjoy this event.

Getting to the event
REGISTRATION is at the St James Homestead in the Clarence Valley, a 30 minute drive 'behind' Hanmer Springs. From behind the Hanmer domain, follow the Clarence/Molesworth/Tennyson Road over Jacks Pass. At the 'T' junction near Clarence River turn left towards Tophouse, and follow 4 km to the tree'd St James homestead. (Accessible also from Nelson/Marlborough via Rainbow and Molesworth Roads, gates permitting). The Start/Finish area is a further 4 km drive up the Clarence River from the St James Homestead.

The road over Jacks Pass and in the Clarence Valley is graveled and often corrugated and pot-holed. It is also prone to snow, so check the forecast and equip and drive accordingly.

Camping is available free at St James Homestead. Camping or cabins are available at Hanmer Springs (we recommend Hanmer Springs Forest Camp, http://www.hanmerforestcamp.co.nz).

Registration and start
Registration starts at **7.45 am** from when maps and electronic wrist-tags are issued. Ensure your team is together and that you have your **completed indemnity form** with you. Briefing is at **9.15 am** at the **start/finish** (15 minute drive beyond St James). Ensure that you register the electronic wrist-tag you have been given on one of the BRIEF punches which will be available at this briefing. The event will start at **9.30 am**. For details on using the Navlight Electronic Scoring System see the homepage of the website http://www.rogaine.org.nz.

The event will close at **4.30 pm sharp** at the **START/FINISH**. If you finish after that you will be penalised 10 points per minute late.

Finish
As soon as you finish, register your wrist-tag on any one of several FINISH Punches, assemble your team, and then present yourselves to the computer desk to have your wrist-tags removed and scored. Wait for an immediate printout of your score. Scores will be notified on the day and published on http://www.rogaine.org.nz as soon as possible after the event.

Event chronology

7.45am	REGISTRATION opens, St James Homestead. Route planning and preparation begins
9.00 am	Teams drive by now to Start/Finish, 4 km northward beside Clarence River
9.15 am	Briefing
9.30 am	START
4.30 pm	FINISH

We will provide a light meal (soup, bread, BBQ sausage, drink) from 4.30 pm at St James.

What to bring
Clothing and safety equipment is listed under 'Safety Sheet'. You will also need

- marker pens, pencils and highlighters, for planning your route
- eating utensils for after the event
- a camp stool and 'flat surface' for course planning (optional but handy). In the event of inclement weather be prepared to plan in your car.

Navigation devices such as GPS or altimeter are **not allowed**.

Food and drink
Carry enough for a long day in the field. You may return to the start-finish at any time for a rest, or a drink. Water is available at Registration and the S/F. Elsewhere, we'd be happy to drink from local streams as long as they are running clear. We recommend you each carry at least 2 litres of water.

Your back country travel skills.
If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, we suggest you confine your route to more accessible check points.

Particular hazards:

Roads: The road is open at all times, and there is no event warning signage. Road Code rules apply (keep to the side)**.**
Fire risk: The area is a high fire risk, depending on winds and dryness. No fires.
Exposure to wind, cold, rain: In poor weather this is very exposed, high country area.

Cancellation
This event will only be cancelled if conditions are extreme, to be notified at the start. We could shorten the event for safety or other reasons.

Registration and event procedure
At the registration desk please present your completed team Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form. Ensure you have entered your team number on the form. You will be issued with:

- one event map and a checkpoint description per team member. The map size is A3 at a scale of 1:35,000. A medium-weight zip-loc plastic bag to protect the map is provided.
- a single black/white version of the map to be used as your "flight plan". Enter your team number and plot your intended route on this map, including direction of travel, and return it to registration before you leave for the start. (You may subsequently modify your route according to conditions as you progress).
- Electronic wrist-tags – two per team. These **MUST** be worn on the wrist with the security band provided.

We recommend you spend at least 45 minutes planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding. You should plan your route carefully to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but to stay within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, your experience and fitness.

Your team may visit any number of checkpoints and in any order, aiming to maximise your 'score'. There are about 40 checkpoints, each with a unique number. The score value is the first digit followed by a zero. Thus check point number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90 points.

All members of your team must attend the event briefing. Each person in your team issued with a wrist-tag must register their wrist-tag on one of the BRIEF Punches as you enter the briefing area. All teams start the event together. Concentrate on your own team plan; do not try to follow other teams.

Each checkpoint comprises an orange/white flag on a stake or tied to a bush or rock etc., and an electronic punch. As they have been placed in the field up to 2 weeks before the event we cannot be certain that all are still intact. If a checkpoint is missing, describe its presumed location to the score keepers to be credited with points.

When you visit a checkpoint EACH COMPETITOR with a wrist-tag places the Punch in their wrist-tag until a red flashing light is seen. (Less than 3 seconds, and probably half a second). If the punch doesn't flash, write down the 3-letter code visible inside it. (See the top of the homepage of the website http://www.rogaine.org.nz to access further details on 'NAVLIGHT').

Safety Sheet
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This area can be very exposed to wind, rain and cold, even on lower ground. Expect the best weather – and prepare for the worst.

Compulsory clothes and equipment per team member:

thermal top & trousers	thermal hat and gloves
shower proof/windproof coat	survival sheet or pack liner
whistle	
food, water bottle	first aid kit, **per team**
at least one compass, **per team**	
suitable, robust, well-fitting footwear with well-treaded soles	

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers may do checks. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We **strongly recommend** you also carry
fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters, showerproof over trousers, hi-viz vest, compass each, torch, watch.

Safety is a top priority. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety. Your responsibilities include:

- Being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers
- Carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment (see above).
- Advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event.
- Staying together as a team at all times, and helping any other team you find in difficulties.
- Depositing a 'flight plan' map showing your intended course before you start.
- Advising organisers, and returning your tags, if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- Being conscious of time and avoiding a late return – which results in a hefty points penalty as well as raises safety concerns.
- Being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this.
- Monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required

- Looking out for hazards, such as:
    - **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Seek shelter or call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. In severe weather, keep off high, exposed areas.
    - **Dehydration.** Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry 2 litres each, be alert to heat exhaustion.
    - **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.
    - Cliffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, firm scree, incised creeks, gullies, hidden holes, etc. may be present throughout the event area.
    - **Rock fall.** Be particularly careful about rocks falling from above, and avoid releasing them above team members or other teams. Shout out if you see falling rocks.
    - **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud, and descend out of it.
    - **Road traffic**: Expect light traffic on the road. Road Code applies.
    - **Hunters**: We cannot guarantee that hunters will not be present in the area. We recommend teams carry a high-viz garment, and that you keep highly visible, and heard, if you are concerned.

In the event of serious injury or exhaustion, make injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the road and central 4wd track.
Emergency signal: repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast. There is no cell phone coverage in the event area.

Environmental care

Please reinforce the rogaining ethic of being an environmentally and socially friendly activity.

- Protect plants and animals
- No rubbish – remove any you find
- Bury toilet waste – better still, don't create it in the field
- Keep streams and tarns clean
- **Strictly no fires**
- TREAD LIGHTLY wherever you go. Take particular care in wetlands areas – it is faster for you, and better for the plants, for you to walk around rather than through them.

Biosecurity Alert – Didymo

This is a high risk area for the invasive algae Didymo. Before leaving home:
- Thoroughly clean (detergent or bleach) and dry footwear and other items
- Do not unnecessarily enter local streams beyond the course.
- Thoroughly clean and dry when back home.

More info at www.biosecurity.govt.nz/didymo

BASIC INFORMATION

Rules in brief

- Use compass and rogaine event map only. No GPS and altimeter units, including watches with altimeters.
- Travel only on foot.
- Team members to stay within verbal contact of each other at all times. **All members** must approach within 20 metres of each checkpoint. (Your fellow competitors will be watching).
- If a check point is missing be able to describe the local setting in detail to the organizer. When visiting the START/FINISH, all team members must report to the organiser and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. You may still go out again later.
- If a competitor wishes to withdraw, the entire team must return to START/FINISH and notify the organisers. (Team retains current points score). Teams of one are not permitted.
- Event finishes at 4.30 pm. (or as specified at start).
- When your team finishes, **all** members **must** report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. Then immediately report to the scoring table to have your wrist-tags removed and scored

Procedure at each control

- All team members must use the electronic Punch to register on their wrist-tags. If a Punch fails to operate record its internal 3-letter code (visible through the clear plastic) to verify your visit, and after you finish and have returned your wrist-tags inform the event organizer.

Points value, penalty points

- Checkpoints 100, 101 are worth 100 points. Thereafter, checkpoints 20 to 29, are worth 20 points, 30 to 39, 30 points, etc.
- 10 points penalty for each minute late. 30 minutes late - all points lost

Safety

- Carry and wear suitable clothing and equipment
- Team to remain together at all times
- Be alert to exhaustion, dehydration, sun, and/or hypothermia
- Help other teams having problems
- If your team withdraws from the event you **must report to admin**. Otherwise you will be reported overdue and a search will be mounted.
- Take **care on the road, which remains open to traffic.**

Emergencies

- Emergency signal: repeated, short whistle blasts
- Repeat if you hear one long blast

Serious injury

- Make injured person warm and comfortable
- Leave someone with injured person if more than two in team.
- Note your exact location on map
- Seek help from other teams and/or go back to base by a direct route or the road.

Farm/land courtesy

- No **rubbish**, no **dogs**, no **fires**, no **firearms**
- Report any damage, etc. to event organisers
- Biosecurity alert - Didymo

TEAM NUMBER: _____

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Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following has been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organizers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18.
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.